Judges' Q&A

Wesal platform. Expected committee questions and answers. KSCDR_Hackathon_151. For the team's internal use.

The problem and the need

1. What problem does Wesal solve?

A person with a disability usually knows their rights well, but it takes a lot of effort to reach them. They have to go through dozens of government and private platforms, one by one, and most are not built for their needs. Wesal brings all of this together in one place that is trusted and easy to use.

Example: a wheelchair user knows the support they are entitled to. But every time, they look for suitable transport. They check that places are ready for them and confirm today's procedure. They check each detail in a different source, and that source is often not built for them.

The gap we close is not about telling people about services they did not know. We cut the time, the effort and the need to depend on others.

2. The Digital Government Authority has regulations and the Unified Platforms Code that require platforms to be accessible. So what problem are you solving?

Yes, and the regulations show this is a national priority. We are with them, not against them. But they govern each government platform on its own, and three gaps remain: the private sector, which procedure fits a person's case, and time. Our proof: with more than 200 users, people reached their information 95% faster with Wesal, even with the official sites available. We complete the platforms, we do not replace them.

- Private sector: the Code is for government platforms, and people also deal with airlines, banks and telecoms.
- The right procedure: an accessible platform lets the person enter and use it. But it does not tell them which procedure fits their case (their chair type, for example), or gather steps from more than one entity.
- Time: implementation is gradual. Entities get their certificate of compliance with the Code one by one, and the person needs the answer today.
- We add, we do not replace: we send the user to the official page and show the source. We follow WCAG 2.2, the standard for accessible websites. And we can give entities indicators on the barriers users face.

3. The information already exists on government platforms, so what is the real gap?

The gap is in reaching the information, not in whether it exists. It is spread across airline sites, airport sites and official platforms, and the person has to compare them by hand. It differs by type of disability. Its sources may also not work with a screen reader, the software that reads a page aloud. We do not say we create the information. We gather it, simplify it and show its source.

Today's alternatives: airline and airport websites, official government platforms, and asking other people.

The problem with them: the user searches, compares and checks everything alone. This takes longer, and the user needs more help from others.

4. How big is the problem and how many people does it affect?

According to the General Authority for Statistics, about 1.35 million people have a disability. That is 5.9% of the Kingdom's population. Among people with only one disability, 52.6% have a mobility disability and 21.8% a visual one. These are the two largest groups by a wide margin.

Source: General Authority for Statistics, Disability Statistics Publication 2023, based on the 2022 Census.

5. How did you validate that the need is real?

We confirmed it with a study and a real test. First, we ran a needs study with the people we serve and others involved, to check the size of the problem and whether our solution fits. Then we tested a working trial version with more than 200 users with disabilities on real tasks.

The link to the study form is in our Arabic presentation, as a QR code you scan with your phone.

6. Who is Khaled and what is his story?

Khaled is an example character: a 24-year-old Saudi man who uses a wheelchair and got the chance to attend a conference outside his city. He found the trip was more than booking a ticket: must he ship his chair? Which battery type is allowed? Who is responsible if the chair does not arrive? He described his case to Wesal in one sentence, and within seconds got an answer that fit his case, based on the rules of the General Authority of Civil Aviation.

Khaled stands for the user's need: to know exactly what to do and which services are available to him, without asking anyone or searching many websites.

His line: "I want to know exactly what I need to do and what services are available to me."

7. What does the problem do to a person in daily life?

The problem has four effects on a person's daily life. First, wasted time: confirming one fact can take hours. Second, the person loses independence, because they depend on other people's help and guesses. Third, the information is not guaranteed, because instructions are sometimes outdated or inaccurate. Fourth, the sources are scattered across airport sites, airlines and official bodies.

Today there is no single reference that gathers these procedures and makes sure the person can manage on their own, safely. The problem is not that the information is missing. The problem is the search for it, which becomes a barrier.

Users and target groups

1. Who is Wesal's primary user?

Our primary users are people with disabilities in the Kingdom. Our main groups are mobility, visual, hearing and cognitive disabilities. But the current version focuses on mobility and visual disabilities. Our example is Khaled, who is 24, uses a wheelchair and manages his own affairs. He needs help when procedures are not clear.

We add the other groups step by step. For more, see the question "What about deaf and hard of hearing users and cognitive disabilities?"

2. Why start with mobility and visual disabilities?

Because they are the two largest groups among people with a single disability: 52.6% and 21.8%, according to the General Authority for Statistics. And because our platform today has text, voice and screens that suit their needs, so it serves them well. We chose to do two groups well to begin with, instead of promising everyone an incomplete service.

3. What about deaf and hard of hearing users and cognitive disabilities?

Right now we support two groups only: mobility and visual disabilities, because those are the groups we tested with. Hearing disabilities need sign language support, which is not available yet. We are working on adding it with specialists. For cognitive disabilities, we add support after testing it with users and partner associations. We add a group only when we are sure it is served properly.

Our timeline puts expanding the groups and building tools that make digital access easier in 2029. The chat also has a "simple" mode that helps some users, but we do not announce support for what we have not tested.

4. Who are the secondary users?

The secondary users are associations and organizations, government entities, specialists, schools and universities, caregivers and parents. Their need is close to the primary user's. They want a fast, easy answer with a known source.

Entities also benefit from indicators of the barriers users face. These help them get their digital services ready, so that they are easier for people with disabilities.

5. Does Wesal serve families and caregivers?

Yes, we serve them. Their questions are the same as the user's: what are the rights? Where do I apply? Which documents do I need? Whom do I contact? The answers have the same documented sources. We also plan advanced tools for specialists and caregivers in a higher plan.

6. Why should the answer differ from one person to another?

Because what fits one person may not fit another. For example, what suits a manual wheelchair user may not suit an electric wheelchair user. In the current version the user picks the answer style, simple or detailed, and can add optional profile details so the answer fits them better. A full personal profile of their needs is a planned feature.

وصـــال
Wesal

The solution and the product

1. What is Wesal in one sentence?

Wesal is a Saudi AI assistant that helps people with disabilities reach complex digital services and procedures through easy, trustworthy steps.

Wesal is a Saudi platform that makes digital information and services easier: easier to reach, to understand and to act on. It turns complex, scattered information into guidance that fits each person, is accessible and trustworthy, so users take their next step on their own.

2. How does Wesal work, step by step?

Five simple steps. You ask, by typing or by voice. Wesal understands what you mean and what you need. It finds the information in our selected Saudi sources. It simplifies the answer and arranges it for your needs and preferences. Then it gives you an accessible answer, as text or voice, with the next steps.

3. What is ready today and what is planned?

Ready today: a working beta at wesalinnovation.sa, tried by more than 200 real users. It has a chat with official sources, a Saudi voice and quick accessibility settings. Planned means not done yet: direct links with service entities, more disability groups, a full personal accessibility profile, document analysis and regional expansion.

Also ready: a control panel and surveys, user roles, and answers that appear step by step. We say it plainly: anything we have not tested with users, we call planned.

4. How does Wesal differ from government portals and general search?

Three differences. First: Wesal gives you one path with steps you can follow, while portals hold information spread across separate services, and general search gives many results you sort out yourself. Second: accessibility for people with disabilities is built in from the start. In portals it varies from one platform to another, and general search is not made for disability. Third: our information is Saudi and in Arabic.

In short: one journey instead of scattered information, accessibility from the first design, and trusted Saudi knowledge you can act on.

5. What are Wesal's features?

Our Arabic deck lists six Wesal features: specialized Saudi knowledge, a smart companion that walks you through a procedure step by step, and analysis of digital barriers. Also a personal accessibility profile, smart matching to the right service, and a memory of your journey, so you finish procedures without repeating steps.

6. What does the answer the user sees look like?

The answer starts with a one-line summary, then the steps in short points. Next comes the responsible entity and its official channel by name, and one follow-up question. Below it are three suggested follow-up questions and official sources, when the answer is built on official pages.

Users have two modes for the answer. Simple mode is about 120 words in very short sentences. Detailed mode gives the steps and the entity responsible for each step.

7. What is in the platform besides the chat?

Besides the chat, there is a personal account with an optional profile. Chats are saved in the user's browser. Users can send a support request, download their data and delete their account. The team has a dashboard: users, roles, messages, tickets, invitations, surveys and editing the home page content.

There is also an internal workspace for managing projects. It uses the same account, role and login as the platform. Our Arabic presentation shows the smart chat, resources and the dashboard.

وصـــال
Wesal

Technology and AI

1. Which model do you use, and did you train your own?

The Wesal model is built on ALLaM, the Saudi Arabic language model from SDAIA, the Saudi Data and AI Authority. We trained it on questions, answers and data from our official sources. We run it on our own servers inside the Kingdom, and our rules stop it from making things up or diagnosing.

- ALLaM is a Saudi model designed for the Arabic language, developed by the National Center for AI at SDAIA.
- We did not start from scratch, because the value is in our data, our official sources and our safety rules. We took ALLaM and continued its training.

2. How are you different from ChatGPT, Claude or the others?

ChatGPT, Claude and others are strong models, and I use them every day for my personal tasks. But they are built for everyone: they do not guarantee the accuracy of Saudi procedures, they do not commit to an official source, and they may answer when they are not sure. Wesal answers from official Saudi sources, shows you the source, and says “I don’t know” instead of making things up. And it is made for the disability community in Saudi Arabia, one of our own, one that understands us and exactly what we need.

The differences in short:

- Information: from official Saudi sources, not the open internet, and we show the source under the answer.
- Honesty: if we find no source we say “I don’t know” and point you to the official entity.
- Limits: we do not diagnose or give medical or legal opinions.
- Accessibility: Saudi voice, screen reader support, bigger text and a simple mode with short sentences.
- Review: our medical team reviews health content before publishing.
- Testing: more than 200 users with disabilities tried it, and 92% completed their tasks.

To be frank: our model is built on ALLaM, and we do not claim our AI is smarter than theirs. We say our sources, safety and accessibility fit this field better.

3. How do you make sure an answer is correct and not made up?

We make the model answer from our official sources, not by guessing. If it finds no source, it says it is not sure and points you to the official authority. Under each answer we show the source, so you can check it yourself. We have five layers of protection in all, and going back to the sources is the first one.

The first layer is going back to the official sources. The other four:

- Rules that stop the model from inventing numbers or links.
- Our system, not the model, decides which source is shown.
- Our medical team reviews health content.
- Any user can report an error with one tap.

4. What is the technical architecture?

Wesal is a simple website that runs in the browser, with nothing to download or install. Behind it are a server, which is the computer that runs the site, and a database of ours. It connects directly to the AI model that writes the answer. The answer appears word by word. Our official sources are stored in the database, and the answers come from them.

For technical readers: the server runs on PHP, the database is MySQL, and the model is connected through an API.

5. Where is the data stored? Does it leave Saudi Arabia?

No, it does not leave Saudi Arabia. Everything runs inside the Kingdom on our servers: the model, the search in our sources, the voice, and the account data. No outside service receives your question text or your voice. The saved chat list stays in your own browser.

6. What is RAG and how does it work for you?

RAG means we get the information from our official sources first, and then the model answers from it. It is like a student answering with the book open in front of them. Here is how it works for us. We compare the meaning of your question with pieces of our sources. We pick the four closest pieces and give them to the model. If no piece is close enough, we show no source.

7. How accurate are the answers and how do you measure it?

We do not have one accuracy number, and we will not give a number we did not measure. What we did measure: more than 200 users tried Wesal on real tasks. 92% of them finished their tasks, and they were 95% faster than searching by themselves. And we can trace every answer back to its source.

8. Does Wesal learn from users' conversations? Do you train on them?

No, we do not retrain the model on users' words. We save the text of questions and answers with no name or account, to improve the answers. For users who are signed in, we save their words only if they agree. We do not sell data.

9. How do you protect the system from attacks?

The connection to the site is protected, and we do not save passwords as they are. Each person has permissions based on their role, and our system enforces them. If someone stops using it, their session ends automatically: after 30 minutes for users and 15 minutes for our team. There are also limits on requests, checks on uploaded images, and a log of every admin action.

10. What happens if a server goes down?

If a server goes down, questions move automatically to a second copy of the same model on another server. If the reply stops arriving word by word, the browser asks for the full reply at once. Last, some simple information is saved inside the page itself, and we answer from it.

The second copy is the same model with the same weights, on another server. So if one server goes down, the service does not stop.

11. Can the system handle many users?

Today the platform runs on web hosting, and it is enough for the trial stage. More than 200 users tried it. When we grow, we will move it to a cloud service that grows with the load. This is covered by the cloud service budget: SAR 8,000. We also set limits per person, so nobody uses up all the resources.

12. How much does it cost to run?

Our estimate is about SAR 15 per user now. It drops to SAR 3 as we grow. We protect the bill with limits for each person and a daily cap. We also save voices that repeat, so we do not generate them twice.

13. What did you build yourselves and what is ready-made?

We built the whole platform: the interface, the server that runs behind it, the dashboard, and the accounts and roles. We also built the way each answer is linked to its source and shown, and we trained the model on our data. What we used ready-made: ALLaM as the base of the model, the voices that read answers aloud, and the servers the website runs on.

14. How does voice work?

You can ask by voice or by typing. The answer is read to you in a Saudi voice. If the Saudi voice does not work, the browser reads it with your device voice. If your browser cannot turn your speech into text, we do it for you. We turn your recording into text, then delete the recording. We do not keep it.

15. Can someone manipulate the assistant?

We have protections that make this hard. The assistant's instructions stop it from revealing its technical details and bring the chat back to the topic. Our system, not the AI model, decides which sources are shown, so nobody can make it invent an official entity. We also limit the number of questions to prevent abuse.

16. How does it handle Arabic and dialects?

It answers in clear Arabic, in a simple Saudi dialect that is easy to understand. Its sentences are short, and it starts with the summary. The website itself is written in simple standard Arabic. The voices that read the answers are Saudi. English is supported too.

The AI model understands standard Arabic and dialects. But we have not tested every dialect.

17. Can other entities integrate with you? Is the code open?

For now, we do not have a direct connection that other organizations can use. Integration is planned for 2027, with the first two or three service organizations. As for the code, it is on GitHub, a website where programmers keep their programs.

18. How do you monitor the system and know when something is wrong?

We have a dashboard that shows whether replies are working well and fast. It also shows how often a reply was cut off, and why. We keep a record of every admin action. When a user reports an error, the report reaches the content reviewer as a ticket.

19. Does Wesal have a mobile app?

No, we do not have a mobile app right now. Today Wesal is a website. It works on phone and computer from the browser. You do not need to download or install anything. We have not announced an app.

Reliability and sources

1. Where does Wesal's information come from?

Our information comes from official Saudi sources that we select. Our presentation cites more than 40 official sources and more than 120 services. Example entities: the Ministry of Human Resources and Social Development, the Disability Care Authority and the Ministry of Health.

More example entities:

- The Human Resources Development Fund (Hadaf)
- The Ministry of Education
- The Social Development Bank
- The King Salman Center for Disability Research

2. What happens when no reliable source exists for an answer?

Wesal says plainly that there is no reliable source, and points the user to the official entity instead of guessing. If an answer is not based on an official page, no source cards appear under it. That way, the user knows that what they read is general guidance.

The instructions for our AI model say:

- If the information is not certain, say so frankly and direct the person to the official entity
- Do not invent numbers, amounts, percentages or links

3. How does the user see the source of an answer?

Under every answer based on official pages, there is a card for each entity, three at most. Each card shows the entity's logo, name and website address, and opens the exact page we took the information from. An answer not based on an official source shows nothing underneath.

The AI model notes the numbers of the sources it used, without showing them to the user. The system accepts only the sources it fetched itself. So an entity we took nothing from never appears, whatever the model writes.

4. Who reviews the health content and who is accountable for its accuracy?

According to our presentation, health and disability content is written or reviewed by a licensed physician and a clinical pharmacist before publication. We also re-check it periodically. On the team, Lamia Alshahrani supervises the medical side, and Hind Al Mufarrih develops and reviews the medical content. Wesal gives no diagnosis or treatment decision.

5. How do you keep information up to date?

We re-check the content periodically against the updated official sources. We refresh our sources by loading the changed pages again, and the new version replaces the old one. User feedback and error reports turn into improvements.

6. How does a user report an error and what happens next?

Under every answer there is a “Report an error” button. The report includes the answer text, its sources and links, so the reviewer knows which page to check. It then becomes a follow-up ticket with the content reviewer, who tracks it until the information is corrected and the ticket is closed. We also use user feedback after each interaction to improve answers.

Safety, privacy and ethics

1. What data do you collect and how long do you keep it?

We collect account data: name, email, phone and date of birth, plus optional data the user adds: city, disability type and interests. We save a signed-in user's chats only if they agree, and never linked to their account. We keep data while the account exists, and after it is deleted we remove its personal data within 30 days at most.

- We also collect the internet address (IP) to protect the platform.
- The saved chat list stays in the user's own browser and does not show for someone signing in with another account on the same device.
- Users can download a copy of their data, clear their chats and delete their account themselves.
- Chats stay in the statistics with nothing that identifies their owner, and a visitor without an account is anonymous to begin with.

2. Does Wesal give diagnosis or medical or legal advice?

No. Wesal does not give a diagnosis, or medical or legal advice. It helps users understand their rights and what they are entitled to, and how to reach services. For medical and legal decisions, it sends them to a licensed professional. The terms of use say that the answers cannot replace advice from a specialist.

3. Do you comply with the Personal Data Protection Law and SDAIA controls?

We built the platform on data protection principles: we collect the minimum data, we set how long we keep it, and users can download, edit and delete their data. We do not sell data or share it with advertisers, and our privacy policy is public. A formal compliance assessment is a step we plan before expanding.

4. Who is responsible if an answer is wrong?

The answers are guidance, and the final reference is the official entity. This is written in the terms of use. We are not responsible for a decision someone makes relying on the assistant alone. But we do our best to be accurate: sources are shown to the user, we receive error reports, and we review the content.

5. How do you protect disability and other sensitive data?

Your profile data, including disability type, is never shown to any other user. The connection to the site is protected, and your password is never stored as it is. Each person sees only what belongs to their role, and the system enforces this. If you stop using your account, you are signed out automatically: after 30 minutes for users and 15 minutes for team accounts.

- The database is protected from harmful commands, and the sign-in session is protected too.
- We keep a log of sign-ins, permission changes and data exports.
- Every time someone signs out, we clear the account's data from the browser.
- We check uploaded images and block any code inside them.

6. How do you handle sensitive or high-risk cases?

In sensitive cases, Wesal sends the user to the relevant official entity or a qualified specialist. It does not handle the matter itself, because it does not replace official support channels. It also reminds the user to see a licensed professional before any medical decision.

7. Do you sell data? And what is sent to the AI provider?

No, we do not sell data or share it with advertisers, and there are no ads in Wesal. Nothing is sent to any outside provider. The model, the search in our sources and the voice all run on our servers inside the Kingdom. We do not give the model your name, email or profile data.

8. How do you avoid bias and disrespectful language?

The assistant's instructions require it to speak to the person with respect and say “a person with a disability”. They forbid words like “handicapped” and “helpless”. They also ask it to treat the person as a human with rights and choices, not as a case. The design is led by psychology expertise and biomedical engineering expertise. We test features with users and partner associations before we expand.

Accessibility and user experience

1. Which accessibility standards do you follow?

We follow WCAG 2.2, the international accessibility standards. They make websites easier to use for people with disabilities. Government entities rely on them for their platforms. Every change we make to the site is checked against a list: it must work with the keyboard alone, with a screen reader, and with zoom up to 200%. The platform also has a Saudi voice and a simple mode with short sentences.

- We also check high contrast, dark mode and reduced motion.
- And we test every feature with users with disabilities and partner associations before we expand.

2. How did people with disabilities take part in the design?

They took part through testing: we test every feature with users with disabilities and partner associations before we expand, and more than 200 users tried the beta. The design of the experience and identity was led by psychology expertise, with attention to different disabilities and user comfort, together with biomedical engineering expertise for assistive technology.

3. What quick accessibility settings are available?

One button in the top bar opens a “quick settings” panel. It has font size, high contrast, dark mode and reduced motion. It also has a link to the full settings page. The site follows the device settings first. If the user chooses something, that choice comes first and is saved.

- There is no floating button that covers the content.
- The panel comes right after its button in the reading order.
- The Escape key closes it and takes you back to the button you opened it from.

4. How does Wesal work with screen readers and the keyboard?

You can move through the whole site with the keyboard, from the first element to the last. Elements that open and close tell a screen reader their state. The heading has moving text, but its full text is in the page, so a screen reader reads it whole. Before automatic sign-out, a warning message appears.

- The message appears two minutes before automatic sign-out. It says, “Are you still there?”
- Any activity from you extends the session.
- This follows the WCAG criterion “Timing Adjustable” (2.2.1), part of the international accessibility standards.

5. What do you offer people who find typing or reading difficult?

Someone who finds typing hard can ask by voice. Someone who finds reading hard can listen to the answer in a Saudi voice. There is also a simple mode with very short sentences. They can make the text bigger and raise the contrast. The Escape key stops a reply, or stops it being read aloud. This helps people with mobility and visual disabilities in particular.

وصـــال
Wesal

Business and revenue model

1. Who pays for Wesal?

Six groups pay for Wesal, not just individuals: people with disabilities and their families, rehabilitation centers and special needs schools, and government and education entities. Also companies, as part of their social responsibility, supporting associations through group subscriptions, and platform developers who connect their platforms to Wesal.

2. What are the plans and prices?

We have four plans: Basic at SAR 29 a month, Professional at SAR 79, Advanced at SAR 179, and the enterprise plan from SAR 479 a month. Basic has simple smart search, screen reader support, text to speech and saving your last chat. Professional adds a voice assistant you can talk with, unlimited saved chats, and recommendations by disability type.

- Advanced adds document analysis and summaries, priority support, and tools for specialists and caregivers.
- Institutions get multiple accounts, an admin dashboard, custom information sources and a dedicated account manager.

3. What is the cost per user and when do you break even?

The cost per user is about SAR 15 today, and it falls to SAR 3 as we grow. We estimate break-even 12 to 18 months after launch, which means our income covers our costs. This happens when we reach 1,000 active users or sign 3 government or institutional contracts. The most important factor is institution subscriptions: their margin is high, and they cover our cloud and AI costs.

Why does the cost fall? Because Wesal runs on Saudi hosting inside the Kingdom. So repeating the service in new places gets cheaper as we grow.

4. Who are your competitors and what is your advantage?

The alternatives today are government portals, airline and airport sites, general search, and asking other people. Our advantage: one platform for people with disabilities, instead of separate bodies. Accessibility is built in from the start. It is built for the Saudi and Arab context. Its answers are tied to their source, and you can act on them.

5. Why would a person with a disability pay when government information is free?

True, reading government information is free. But it costs you time, effort and dependence on other people. The Wesal platform gives you guidance in one place that is accessible and fits your situation. Individuals do not always have to pay: associations, schools, entities and companies fund group subscriptions. The lowest plan is SAR 29 a month.

The trial version is free right now. You can try it at once without an account, with a limited number of questions. After you register, you get a bigger credit that renews by itself every 6 hours.

6. Do you have partnerships or customers now?

So far we have users, not customers. More than 200 users have tried the trial version. For partnerships, our goal in year one is 3 associations. We plan to start with a trial launch. It will be in 3 rehabilitation centers and special needs schools in Riyadh.

7. What are the expected revenue sources?

In the first 6 months of year one we expect income from four sources: school and association subscriptions, individual subscriptions, sponsorships and partnerships, and custom services for entities. In the longer term, income grows from subscriptions by government entities and institutions.

In the longer term:

- Annual subscriptions for government entities and institutions.
- Group subscriptions supported by associations.
- Affordable individual subscriptions.
- Solutions for care centers.

8. What budget is needed and how is it split?

We need SAR 36,000 in total. The biggest items are AI technologies at 10,000 and cloud hosting at 8,000. Next are marketing and launch at 5,000 and an emergency reserve at 5,000. The rest are interface design at 3,000, usability testing at 3,000 and website tools at 2,000.

9. What is your plan to reach users?

We start in Riyadh and grow in phases. Phase one: launch in 3 rehabilitation centers and special needs schools in Riyadh. Then we expand across the Central, Western and Eastern regions. After that, the whole Kingdom, and then the Gulf. The goal for year one is 1,000 registered users and partnerships with 3 associations.

- In phase one we have 200 pilot users. With them we check how accurate the answers are, and we tune performance.
- This phase is backed by funding from incubators and accelerators.

10. How will you fund the first phase?

We fund the first phase from incubators and accelerators (programs that support startups), from grants and innovation awards, and from company sponsorships as part of their social responsibility. That includes early pilot funding from the telecom and banking sectors. After that, our income comes from subscriptions.

The subscriptions we expect after that:

- Annual ones for government entities and institutions.
- Group ones through associations.
- Affordable individual ones.
- Solutions for care centers.

Impact, results and validation

1. What results did the beta achieve?

The result: 92% of the users finished their tasks. They found what they needed 95% faster than searching on their own. We tested a working beta with more than 200 users with disabilities, using real tasks. And we can trace every answer back to its source.

We measured four things:

- Can people with disabilities use the platform without barriers?
- Does the answer fit the question?
- Can we trace the answer back to its source?
- Is it easy to use?

2. What are your year-one targets?

Our targets for the first year: 1,000 registered users and partnerships with 3 associations. We keep task success at 90% or higher for 12 months. We want 100% of answers to come with a source. We want user satisfaction at 4.5 out of 5 or higher. And we aim to cover visual, hearing, mobility and cognitive disabilities.

- What we reached in testing: 92% with more than 200 users.
- What we aim for: keeping 90% or higher with 1,000 active users.

3. Who were the 200 users and how did you choose them?

They are users with disabilities who tried a working version on real tasks. We checked whether the platform suits them and has no barriers, and whether the answer fits their question. We also checked whether we can trace each answer to its source, and whether it is easy to use. We repeat the same test method in the next measurement, so we can compare the impact.

4. How did you measure these results?

We measured in three ways: a test where users carry out tasks, a survey inside the platform after each session, and usage numbers: the number of sessions, the share of answers that come with a source, and the time we save compared with searching on their own. We repeat the same method in the next round and review it every three months with partner associations.

5. What impact do you expect at scale?

We expect an impact on about 1.35 million people with disabilities: digital services become designed for them from the start instead of being a barrier. That means more independence and a better quality of life, less dependence on caregivers for basic information, and easier access to education and jobs. For the Kingdom, it is a national example of an inclusive Arabic AI.

6. How does Wesal connect to Vision 2030?

The Wesal platform supports the commitment of the Vision to the full participation of people with disabilities. It is in line with WCAG 2.2, the standards for digital accessibility. It is also in line with the digital inclusion guide of the Kingdom. In 2030 we plan to measure the social and economic impact. We also plan to bring our indicators in line with the Vision.

7. What will you measure after launch?

After launch we measure four things: the share of users who finish their tasks, the share of answers that come with a source, the time we save them, and their satisfaction. We review them every three months with partner associations. For the entities that provide services, we measure the barriers users face and give them indicators that raise the readiness of their services.

Sustainability, growth and team

1. What is your plan from 2026 to 2030?

Our plan covers five years. 2026: we build the first version and test it with a sample of people with disabilities. 2027: official launch, with direct links to the first two or three entities. 2028: links with government and private entities, expanding into health, education, transport and work. 2029: new groups and tools that make digital access easier. 2030: our goal is to become an approved national platform.

- 2026: we also start the first partnerships with associations.
- 2027: we start with the most important services.
- 2029: we use AI to anticipate needs.
- 2030: a platform for digital empowerment and impact measurement.

2. Who is on the Wesal team and what does each person do?

Our team has five members, and each member has a field and a role. Lamia Alshahrani, medicine and surgery: leads the team and the medical supervision. Hind Yahya Al Mufarrih, pharmacy: develops and reviews the medical content. Raneem Saeed Alnujaymi, psychologist: designs the user experience and the identity. Ahmad Sami, AI engineer: the AI model and the platform. Raghad Mohammed Alasiri, biomedical engineering: assistive technology and accessibility.

3. What are the biggest risks you face?

Five risks, each with a remedy. Outdated or inaccurate information: we show the source, review, and take error reports. Depending on one model: we keep a second copy on another server. Running costs as we grow: we set usage limits. Data sensitivity: we control who can see it and collect the minimum. Serving limited groups today: we expand step by step after testing.

4. What are Wesal's weaknesses today?

Wesal today is a beta, not a final product. Here are its limits. It serves mobility and visual disabilities only so far. Its information is limited to the official sources we chose. Saved chats stay in one browser and do not move between devices. It gives no diagnosis, and it does not replace official channels. We say this clearly because trust in our field is built on honesty.

5. Why is this team the right one for this problem?

Because the problem brings together medicine, pharmacy, psychology, artificial intelligence and assistive technology, and our team has a specialist in each one. One goal unites us: using technology to create lasting impact for people with disabilities.

6. How will you expand to the Gulf and beyond?

We expand in order: Saudi Arabia, then the Gulf, then the world. Our system runs over the internet, so we can adapt the content and services for each country easily. As users grow, the cost per user falls from SAR 15 to SAR 3. The main challenge: improving our running costs and the cost of the technical services we depend on.

7. How does Wesal sustain itself?

Wesal keeps going through three things: knowledge, impact and growth. Knowledge: we update our sources when regulations and services change, and turn user feedback into information. Impact: we measure barriers and give entities indicators. Growth: partnerships with service providers, solutions that measure how accessible their services are, and growing as services and users grow.

8. What do you need from the committee and supporting bodies?

We would like four things from you, and they are suggestions from our plan. First, introductions to associations and rehabilitation centers where we can run the first phase in Riyadh. Second, funding or incubation that covers our estimated budget. Third, open channels for direct links with the organizations that provide services, so we can connect their services. Fourth, a partnership to measure impact and review accessibility.